



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
General Certificate of Education Advanced Subsidiary Level

COMMUNICATION SKILLS
PAPER 2

5033/2
2 hours

SPECIMEN PAPER

Additional materials:
Answer booklet

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Write your name, centre number, candidate number and paper number in the spaces provided on the answer booklet.

Answer the **two compulsory** questions from **Section A** and **B**.

Write your answers on the answer booklet provided.

Answer question 1 on the grid answer sheet provided by ZIMSEC in the answer booklet, writing each word in a box.

Begin your answer to **Section B** on a separate sheet of paper.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This specimen paper consists of 8 printed pages.
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SECTION A: SUMMARY (20 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **45 minutes** on this question.

Answer the following question.

1. Read the following passage and answer the question that follows.

SOIL EROSION: ASSAULT ON OUR FARMLANDS

- 1 KwaZulu-Natal farmer, Kie-wiet Campher, drives his truck along the winding road through his farm, near Ladysmith, pointing out one disaster area after another. The devastation caused by a three-metre-high flash flood, which swept through his lands in February 1994, is still horribly apparent two years later. Deep dongas of raw rock scar a handscape littered with the ‘corpses’ of forty-year-old trees, while dams are choked with silt. 5
- 2 The irrigation equipment and more than thirty kilometres of fencing that were swept away can be replaced, but the same cannot be said for the topsoil scoured from adjacent fields. All that is left of those once-productive pastures is rocky substrata carved with gullies. “These fields will never be used again,” observes Francois Poggen-poel, the Department of Agriculture’s Extension Officer for the area. “So much soil has been lost that we cannot reclaim them.” 10
- 3 Flash flooding, now a regular problem in the area, is largely the result of the degradation of water-catchment areas, upstream. Farming and forestry have replaced the indigenous vegetation, hampering the ability of the land to retain water and causing the topsoil to be increasingly washed away. The problem is exacerbated because many of the catchment areas in KwaZulu-Natal fall within over-populated and overgrazed communal lands. 15
- 4 Land degradation is as old as civilization itself. Ancient Sumerian literature dating back to 2000 BC tells how the felling of Mesopotamian forests turned the great ancient grain-producing areas into wastelands. 20
- 5 Erosion of Southern Africa’s farmland by wind and water has been a problem since settlers first began dividing the subcontinent’s vast, communal grazing lands into fenced-off private parcels. As early as 1700, the Governor of the Cape, Willem Adrian van der Stel, expressed concern about the erosive effects of downhill’s ploughing and recommended contour ploughing instead. In 1943, Prime Minister Jan Smuts, perturbed about the farming practices of the time, founded the Anti Waste Committee to protect the country’s natural resources, particularly soil, vegetation and water. 25
- 6 Over the years, the Department of Agriculture has introduced a variety of schemes to try to contain erosion. Extension offices were established to help farmers conserve their soil by building terraces. They also recommended strip cropping as another method of conserving soil. Farmers were encouraged to plant trees as wind breaks. 30

- 7 At the same time, however, politics was conspiring against the Extension Officers' efforts. South Africa was becoming increasingly isolated from the rest of the world and the National Party government pushed for ever-higher crop yields to make the country self-sufficient, regardless of the cost to the environment. Large-scale farmers were encouraged to put marginal lands (those not ideally suited to agriculture) under the plough. 35
- 8 Moreover, the millions of rural communal farmers crammed by apartheid into a small proportion of relatively fragile land, were ignored by the government's advisers. As a result, only fifty percent of cultivated land is considered adequately protected and, after fifty years of conservation efforts, soil erosion is worse than ever before. 40
- 9 "Soil is an irreplaceable resource – once it is gone, it is gone," says Jacques de Villiers, CEO of the National Veld Trust, the conservation body that succeeded the Anti Waste Committee. "It is disgraceful that the government pours millions into all sorts of development schemes, but not into the resource we need for our very survival." 45
- 10 Vetrestitution and monocropping – the practice of putting vast areas under a single crop – are taking a terrible toll. Ours is an arid country, which makes our sixteen percent of arable land valuable, beyond price. Recent surveys of cropland in the Highveld region, considered as one of the country's most productive agricultural areas, show that thirty-six percent has already been severely degraded by erosion. Similarly, almost all the cultivated land in the former homelands is in urgent need of protection to stop further devastation. 50
- 11 Fertile soil is not of unlimited depth. The top-soil on which crops can be raised varies from metres to mere centimetres. Each year, South Africa loses at least 300 million tons of soil through erosion by wind and water, an amount that would fill enough seven-ton trucks to circle the globe seven and a half times. Along with those millions of tons, go vital nutrients needed to sustain growth. The cost of replacing them is estimated at 1 000 million Rands a year. 55
- 12 It takes about forty years to form one millimetre of topsoil through natural processes. What scares experts is that South Africa is estimated to be losing thirty times more soil than the natural rate of soil formation, making erosion in some areas of our country the worst in the world. 60
- 13 So far, farmers have been able to mask the damage by using hybrid seeds and applying increased amounts of chemical fertilisers. However, the day of reckoning is coming nearer. If we keep losing soil at the present rate, our country will eventually be unable to feed its people. The awesome danger we are facing is clear: while the demand for food is increasing by three percent a year, our agricultural capacity is cut by the same percentage for every centimetre of the soil lost. 65

- 14 When soil is eroded from fields, it does not simply move to another spot on the farm. Much of it, laden with chemical fertilisers and pesticides, ends up in streams, rivers and lakes, impairing or ending their use for recreation and water supply, and destroying fish and wildlife habitats. Renowned conservationist, Ian Player, watches with horror the rivers of our east coast empty their red loads of topsoil into the blue Indian Ocean. “We are like people bent on suicide who have slit our wrists and see our blood seeping quietly away,” he says. “In my short lifespan, I have seen so many terrifying changes that I fear we will leave a legacy of misery for our children and grandchildren,” he laments. 70 75
- 15 Wind erosion is a particular problem in areas where monocropping of staples such as maize, sugar cane and wheat is practised. After a harvest, these fields are often left to lie fallow. With immense tracts of bare earth stretching from horizon to horizon, seasonal spring winds whip the topsoil from the surface. 80
- 16 Mpumalanga farmer, Clive Nicholson, understands the social and financial costs of soil erosion. He is a founder member of the Farmer Foundation, a five-year-old organisation offering technical and financial support to some 3 000 small-scale farmers around the country. It is one of a handful of non-governmental organisations attempting to alleviate poverty and prevent environmental degradation. 85
- 17 Nicholson has spent vast amounts of money, battling erosion on his Steencampsberg farm on the Drakensberg escarpment. Not only has he constructed dams and ponds to slow water flow and prevent soil erosion after heavy rains, but you won’t find a piece of veld that’s grazed shorter than four centimetres. He even grows fodder crops to feed his animals during winter so that the veld can rest. 90
- 18 While there are signs that farmers and the government are at last waking up to the problem, neither side yet has a great enough sense of urgency. “Our country is in a very perilous situation,” warns the Veld Trust’s De Villiers. “Without soil, water or vegetation, there will be no quality of life for anyone. If we carry on disregarding our soil, we are all going to starve to death,” he laments. 95

Adapted from: **Readers Digest February 1998:** Article by Jacqui L’ange.

Question

Write a summary on the causes, negative effects and preventive measures of soil erosion.

Your summary, which should be in continuous writing, must not exceed **200** words. [15]

5 marks will be awarded for proficient use of English.

SECTION B: COMPREHENSION (30 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **1 hour 15 minutes** on this section.

2 Read the following passage carefully and then answer all the questions that follow.

- 1 The emergence of the Covid-19 pandemic has impacted society and business in many ways. To ensure business continuity and productivity, local employers have started to implement mandatory vaccination for employees to access workplaces. This means failure to get vaccinated could result in loss of employment for many who are already battling to make ends meet in a challenging economy. Those who are against mandatory vaccination have sought legal recourse, some through their trade unions. 5
- 2 Some trade unions have complained of other coercive behaviour by employers such as booking employees for en-bloc vaccinations without their consent and insisting on Covid-19 testing every fortnight. Against that backdrop, there are two questions that come to mind: is this allowed or legal and secondly, should it be allowed? Before the legalities are explored, it is important to understand these issues from a socio-ethical perspective. 10
- 3 Ideally, business should always operate through the lens of a corporate citizenship perspective, and this should remain the same, in view of the of the Covid-19 pandemic. Corporate citizenship refers to a company's responsibilities towards society aimed at producing higher standards of living and quality of life for the communities that surround them, while maintaining profitability for stockholders and stakeholders. This means that businesses' actions should meet both legal and social expectations. If business actions are against such expectations, then they run the risk of social and legal action. 15 20
- 4 Whether the call for mandatory vaccination by companies is supported by the corporate citizenship, is really a matter of perspective. A balance can be found in the ethos of ethical business practice. Ethical business practice encourages companies to operate in ways that serve their own interests, as well as those of the communities that they affect. Corporate Social Responsibilities (CSR) intends to improve the quality of life for business stakeholders, which include employees, customers and communities. In line with the principles of CSR, businesses should come up with Employee Assistance and Employee Wellness Programmes (EAPs and EWPs) to address the impact of Covid-19 on employees. 25 30
- 5 Presently, "no vaccination, no job" is the song being sung, but no meaningful employee engagements have been initiated by employers. The Employee Wellness Programmes (EWPs) are work-based advisory counselling and support programmes which provide life, health performance and wellness management services to employees, free of charge. Having healthy employees has clear financial benefits and can reduce health care costs for employers. Healthy employees are less prone to sudden illness and stress, leading to greater productivity, increased morale and better relationships. EWPs can also be used as a means to educate employees on the Covid-19 vaccination and provide answers to any questions that they might have about vaccination. 35 40

- 6 This could find more and more employees opting for vaccination as opposed to the aggressive and coercive approach currently used by employers. Related to EWP, but still distinct, are Employee Assistance Programmes (EAPs). These are employee benefit programmes, offered by employers to enable employees deal with personal problems that may adversely impact their work performance, health and well-being. In this instance, the Covid-19 risk allowances that some employers were offering in the beginning, but have since been withdrawn, are an example of an EAP. Employee support programmes as a form of CSR, are not a once-off project. Ideally, companies should have a stand-alone unit, within their Human Resources Departments, that deals with EWP and EAPs. 45 50
- 7 The concern for the employee wellness is continuous practice that is an integral part of ethical business practice. Studies show that when CSR is embedded in daily business practices, it improves the company's image and simultaneously increases profits. Companies can provide Covid-19 health and safety information, guidance, support and provision of Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) such as masks and sanitisers. Companies can also provide Covid-19 vaccinations, without aggressively coercing employees to take them. These seemingly small efforts by companies will benefit society at macro level and ultimately lead to the much needed transformation of corporate culture in Zimbabwe. 55 60
- 8 Employers can take lessons learned from the HIV/AIDS pandemic and apply them to Covid-19. In both cases, a lack of public health guidance left the public vulnerable, resulting in the loss of many lives. With HIV/AIDS, there was legislative development, which led to the National Aids Council and the National Aids Levy that contributed immensely to combating the pandemic. Non-state actors took the initiative and came up with the Zimbabwe Business Council on AIDS, which championed employers' response to HIV/AIDS through developing policies and coordinating HIV/AIDS Employee Wellness Programmes in the workplaces. Covid-19 does not show any signs of leaving anytime soon and so the same approach should be taken. 65 70
- 9 As it stands, Government has not enacted any law that makes vaccination compulsory. However, its pro-vaccination policy is loud and clear and based on this. Employers have taken a hard stance against employees who have opted out of Covid-19 vaccinations, regardless of their reasons for doing so. Given these developments, the topical issue is whether employers should be allowed to make Covid-19 vaccinations mandatory for employees on pain of loss of employment. The significant pieces of legislation to look at are: The Labour Act, Chapter 28:01 and The Public Health Act, Chapter 15:17. 75

- 10** In terms of the Labour Act, the employer has a duty to ensure the health and safety of all employees. Amongst other things, the employer must provide a safe and healthy work environment for all employees. Exposing employees to Covid-19 obviously breaches this duty. This, in itself, can justify an argument for mandatory vaccination of employees. On the other hand, Section 35 of the Public Health Act provides that ‘no health service shall be provided to a person without their informed consent,’ and vaccination falls under a health service in terms of the Public Health Act. Given that, what then constitutes informed consent and what differentiates it from general consent? Without getting too technical, informed consent can only occur once a person is sufficiently educated on the nature of their decision, together with all possible risks and benefits that are associated with the said decision. General consent means to agree without explanation and is required in minor or less invasive instances. Both general and informed consent must be voluntarily or freely given, meaning without any form of coercion or duress. As it stands, employers cannot fire employees for being unvaccinated, but they can put them on unpaid leave, like what other organisations have done, which is of course pressure tactic to ensure employees get vaccinated. ‘Pressure’ violates the principles of consent as it is no longer free or voluntary. 80 85 90 95
- 11** The Constitution is the supreme law of the land. It contains a list of fundamental human rights. Chapter 4:44 of this supreme law states that everyone has a duty to respect, protect, promote and fulfil these rights. Those that oppose mandatory vaccination argue that certain fundamental human rights would be infringed, namely Section 51, which is the right to human dignity, Section 57, the right to privacy; and Section 60, the right to freedom of conscience. However, the rights in Chapter 4 are not absolute and can be limited through a law of general application as provided for in Chapter 5 of the Constitution. A law of general application is a law that must be applied equally to all persons, not selectively or arbitrarily. In addition, the limitation must be ‘fair, reasonable, necessary and justifiable in a democratic society, based on openness, justice, human dignity, equality and freedom.’ 100 105 110

Adapted from: **The Sunday Mail**, 19 September 2021.

Article by: Alexandra Mliswa and Takudzwa Muthende

- (a) Give **one** word from paragraph 1 which means the same as advent. [1]
- (b) From the evidence given in the passage, give a reason why employers have started to implement mandatory vaccination for employees? [1]
- (c) How does failure to get vaccinated negatively impact on the workers? [1]
- (d) In your **own words**, explain the meaning of the phrase ‘through the lens of ...’ (line 14) [1]
- (e) From paragraph 3, which words refer to
- (i) interested parties in an organisation, [1]
- (ii) owners of business or shareholders. [1]

- (f) How can companies strike a balance in their business practices? [2]
- (g) From paragraph 1, quote a phrase of **two consecutive words** that imply a forceful treatment. [1]
- (h) Explain how employers can ensure that their employees opt for vaccination without coercion. [2]
- (i) **Compare** and **contrast** the government's responses to the HIV/AIDS and Covid-19 pandemics. [2]
- (j) 'This, in itself...' (line 83) What does the word 'this' refer to? [1]
- (k) Why is the word 'pressure' in (line 97) put in quotation marks? [1]
- (l) In your **own words**, explain the meaning of the phrase 'informed consent'. (line 86) [2]
- (m) Of what importance is the supreme law of the land? [1]
- (n) (i) Explain the meanings of **any three** of the following words as they are used in the passage. You may write the answer as one word or a **short phrase** of not more than **seven words**.
1. prone (line 37)
 2. distinct (line 43)
 3. impact (line 45)
 4. simultaneously (line 55)
 5. combating (line 66)
 6. enacted (line 72)
- [3]
- (ii) Use the **three** words that you have chosen, in (n)(i) above, in **three separate** sentences to illustrate their meanings as used in the passage. Your sentences should not deal with the subject matter of the passage. Each sentence should have enough context to demonstrate that you know the meanings of the words. [3]
- (o) 'A law of general application is a law that must be applied equally to all persons, not selectively or arbitrarily.' Differentiate the meanings of the words 'selectively' and 'arbitrarily'. [2]
- (p) 'Covid-19 does not show any sign of leaving anytime.' (line 70 – 71)
What does this expression show about the author's attitude towards the end of the pandemic. [1]
- (q) (i) What style of writing did the author use? [1]
- (ii) Give a reason for your answer to (q)(i). [1]
- (r) Suggest a possible title for this passage. [1]